

Meeting Summary & Strategic Analysis

Executive Summary

This meeting focused on navigating AI trading risks, personal tax efficiency strategies, and collaborative course creation. **Bora** shared his frustration with AI prediction models and high trading fees erasing edges. **Rifat** proposed a tax-efficient long-term investing alternative using UK salary sacrifice into SMR nuclear stock (**Rolls-Royce**) and demonstrated collaborative learning tools. **Marianna** provided strategic insights on market value perception, resisting AI over-reliance, and keeping communications simple.

Core Discussion Topics & Insights

1. Predictive Markets & AI Frustrations (Bora & Rifat)

- **The AI Trading Paradox:** High-frequency prediction models (e.g., Polymarket, futures, copy trading) are failing to find a sustainable edge because **transaction/taker fees erase small margins**.
- **High Reasoning vs. Execution:** AI models are becoming extremely risk-averse, often advising *against* taking trades due to high friction costs, leaving automated projects stalled.
- **Over-Engineering Trap:** Builders often get addicted to the building process rather than focusing on end-user value delivery.

2. Long-Term Wealth & UK Tax Strategies (Rifat & Marianna)

- **60% Tax Trap:** Income between £100k and £125k faces severe taxation in the UK.
- **Salary Sacrifice & Single Stock Strategy:** Rifat suggested sacrificing income into pensions/SIPPs to avoid high tax brackets and making zero/low-fee long-term bets on structural tailwinds (e.g., **Rolls-Royce SMRs** powering future AI energy needs).
- **The eToro / Fee Model:** Short-term day trading incurs excessive swap and transaction fees. Long-term, low-frequency accumulation limits fee erosion.

3. AI Value Perception & Cognitive Load (Marianna)

- **The "Token Trap":** AI platforms are incentivized to keep users consuming tokens and generating text rather than solving problems directly.
- **Market Perception:** Value isn't intrinsic—it depends on context, market need, and clarity.
- **Analog Grounding:** Using pen and paper helps ground decisions and prevents developers from getting lost in AI-induced "dizziness."
- **Simplification Request:** Content and business score feedback should be concise, clear, and human-digestible rather than overwhelming.

4. Collaborative Course Production (Rifat, Bora, Marianna)

- **Delivery Pilots:** Rifat presented a collaborative framework on School/Github/Camba to build certified AI courses using short, 3-minute video modules.
- **Human-in-the-Loop:** Course modules feature seamless handoffs from AI scripts to real-world IDE demonstrations by Rifat.

Action Items & Next Steps

- **Bora:** Continue studying towards AI certifications to target new UK contracting roles; review simple collaborative course feedback on Camba.
- **Marianna:** Explore Triton Square/Cambridge meetups; continue testing human-centric value definitions.
- **Rifat:** Refine short video transitions (addressing Sude/Bora's feedback) and streamline business score summaries to reduce cognitive load.
- **All:** Keep Sunday calls capped at **1 hour** (transitioning towards evening slots if preferred).

Cleaned Transcript

Rifat: How are you today? Can you hear me?

Bora: Yes, I can hear you. Now I sorted out the echo issue.

Rifat: How was your week, Bora?

Bora: Yeah, it was okay. I was just in Antalya and came back last Monday.

Rifat: You're back in the UK now?

Bora: Yeah, I'm in the UK right now and I'm trying to adapt to the weather and everything.

Rifat: Alright, so this was the weather you were not expecting after Antalya?

Bora: Yeah, it was kind of rainy, but today is nice though.

Rifat: Yes, today is much nicer, definitely. I'm trying to test out the platform from my mobile phone and desktop at the same time. I created a "Murali M" user—Murali is a co-worker of mine. I didn't want to use the same name so I could test the setup properly. So, how is Polymarket going?

Bora: Well, it's not going well, actually. The models I'm using keep trying to find an edge, but there's no edge so far. They keep trying, but it's not going well. I'm kind of frustrated with that. They start a research project, run it for a couple of weeks, can't find an edge, and then just shelf the project and try another strategy. It just goes on and on. I don't know what to do.

Rifat: I play poker a bit, so when you use terms like "edge," that relates to poker for me. It's all about predicting outcomes. I also had an account on eToro and opened some positions three weeks ago. Predicting the future is trying to guess the unknown. You're trying to use deterministic tools, but even a great model is just taking a bet—at the end of the day, you make the bet, not the model.

Bora: The model tries to find mispricings, but the problem is the fees. The fees end up erasing all the edge.

Rifat: The transaction fees on eToro or Polymarket?

Bora: Yes, there are a lot of fees.

Rifat: I worked at B2C Trader, a Bitcoin company. They took small fees, but so many people were scalping that the frequent trading ate away their edge. Unless you have a real edge in high-frequency trading, you're in the same boat as everyone else.

In poker, everyone learns pre-flop and post-flop rules, so the structural edge disappears.

Switching topics slightly—in the UK, there's something called salary sacrifice. Do you know how salary sacrifice works, Bora?

Bora: Not really.

Rifat: After £100,000, you face tax rates from 40% up to a 60-65% marginal trap. Instead of paying that tax, people use salary sacrifice to put money into pensions or high-risk trading/ISA accounts. Instead of paying 65% tax, you effectively keep more value.

Hello, Marianna!

Marianna: Hello, I'm fine, how are you?

Rifat: I'm doing fine. I opened the Murali M account to test video stream quality on another screen. We were just discussing prediction markets with Bora.

A while back, I made a 30-40% profit on eToro copy trading, but after six months, I gave up. I realized I had become a day trader. Do you know what a day trader is, Marianna?

Marianna: Someone who is buying and selling every day?

Rifat: Exactly. I realized I couldn't predict the future long-term. Even when I made money, swap fees and holding costs destroyed long-term gains. So Bora, what is your plan going forward with AI and trading?

Bora: I just keep trying with AI, looking for a future edge. But so far, it's frustrating. The models run for weeks, burn through tokens, and then tell me to shelf the project because they can't overcome the maker/taker fees.

Rifat: That's why I brought up salary sacrifice. If you earn over £100k, instead of placing high-frequency bets, you can take a long-term position in a single solid stock. My thesis right now: AI requires massive energy. I'm contracting in the energy sector, and I plan to buy Rolls-Royce stock in small chunks long-term. Rolls-Royce is building Small Modular Reactors (SMRs).

AI token costs and energy usage will skyrocket. Energy is the foundational layer underneath AI.

Marianna: Is salary sacrifice a government incentive?

Rifat: Yes, the UK government incentivizes saving into pensions by giving tax relief. If you put £40k into pensions annually, the tax saved almost matches what you put in.

(Rifat shares his screen to demonstrate tax software and fee calculators)

If you make 12 trades a year instead of 1,000, fee impact drops drastically. On eToro or standard brokers, high trading frequency ruins small accounts.

Bora: So if you deposit £100 a month, you limit fees and capture the tax savings instead?

Rifat: Exactly. Over 10 years, depositing £12,000 can yield significant compound value without losing 60% to taxes or getting eaten up by trading fees.

Marianna: For me right now, I don't earn in those high brackets, so it's not directly applicable today, but it is interesting to see how the system works.

Rifat: What Marianna said earlier is crucial: value perception. Bora has archived 15 private AI repositories because they didn't make money. But what is the true value we are creating with AI? Marianna, how do you see this?

Marianna: Value depends on market perception. You can create tools all day, but if the market doesn't perceive or need that value right now, it won't yield results.

Bora, I noticed you said, "I am following the AI." You are letting the AI guide you like a boss rather than using it as a tool to execute your own direction. AI models are built to consume tokens—they provoke us to ask more questions and keep us lost in information flow.

Sometimes using pen and paper brings clarity that AI cannot give.

Bora: In my trading context, the AI reasoning has gotten so strict that whenever I receive a buy

signal from a strategy, the AI analyzes it and says "don't trade" because fee risks are too high. So it ends up blocking every trade!

Rifat: That's hilarious, but also useful! AI is telling you to hit the brakes. I use AI to calculate a "business confidence score" on my ideas to stop me from building aimlessly.

Marianna: But you can't trust AI 100%. If you follow it blindly, you get lost in an illusion of control. The people investing millions into these AI platforms build them to control market flow and earn token revenue, not necessarily to make us rich.

Rifat: That's a sharp perspective. Value depends entirely on context and constraints. Like a bottle of water: it's free at a tap, £1 in a cafe, and £3 at the airport security gate.

Marianna: Exactly. You have to find the market where your specific value is needed right now.

Rifat: Let's discuss our course production platform. We are collaboratively building AI certification courses (Cloud 101, Core Prompting). Instead of one instructor making a course, we build 3-minute bite-sized modules together. The AI creates the base script, and then I do a live hands-on coding handover in the IDE.

(Marianna shares her screen, navigating the course platform and reviewing the Camba feedback tool)

Marianna: The feedback tool is clear, but we need to keep the visual and textual information simple. The human mind can only process so much information at once.

Bora: I saw Sude's comment on the module transition—the jump between the AI avatar and your live voice needs to be smoother. But overall, the collaborative format is great.

Rifat: Excellent feedback. My goal is for all of us—Bora, Marianna, Sude, and myself—to build these courses, share them on LinkedIn, build our networks, and land strong contracting roles. Bora, what is your primary focus right now?

Bora: My main goal is to get certified, improve my AI infrastructure skills, and land a solid Unix/AI systems contracting role in London.

Rifat: Brilliant. Let's wrap up here to respect everyone's time. We will keep these Sunday calls to **1 hour**, and look into scheduling evening slots. Thank you both for a great session!

Marianna: Thank you! Bye!

Bora: Bye everyone.